https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/

Essay

12000 Words

Essay QRN: —

*Write connecting words/lines/**quotes** between Paragraphs. Thus/However/Therefore/Questions = **Flow***

- History
  - Ancient/Medieval
  - Modern
    - Gandhi
    - Freedom Struggle
    - Social reformers
  - World
  - Post Independence
- Culture
  - Religion/Mythology
  - Spirituality/Yoga
  - Art: Music/Painting
- Geography
  - Darwins' SoF Theory
  - Explorer - Columbus etc
  - Copernicus, Galileo — ***heliocentrism***
- Society
  - I/Family/Society
  - Women
  - LGBTQ
  - Caste/Tribals
- Polity and Governance
  - Constitutional Articles etc
  - Public Servants
  - Judiciary
  - Social Activists - Anna etc
  - NGOs - Civil Society
- Social Justice
  - Education
  - Health/Security
  - Welfare of weaker section
  - Poverty + Hunger
  - Human Resources
- International — UN etc.
  - Country specific example
  - Globalisation
- Others —
  - **Pop Culture - Asif Sir**
  - **COVID19**
  - Current Affairs
  - Art
  - **Sports**
  - Religion
  - Personal and Normal Life
- Economics
  - Growth/Development
  - Infrastructure
  - Energy Security
- Agriculture = Food Security
- Science and Technology
  - Innovation
  - Space
  - AI
  - Nuclear
- Security
  - Naxalism/Terrorism
  - Cyber Security
  - National Security
- Environment + DM
- Ethics & Integrity - Values
  - Morality
  - Kant's Human Dignity
  - Consumerism/Material

Approaches —

Body —

For more such topper notes: https://t.me/+SjK0XLJ6sYZmZjQ1
https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/

1. SPECLIH — (Society, Political...);
2. Causes (Historical evolution and status), Issues, Interventions, Reforms;
3. Short term, Medium term, Long term;
4. Temporal — Past Present Future
5. Stakeholders — Senior citizens, Children, Unborn, Vulnerable - tribals, destitute, women
6. Walks of life — Individual, Family, Professional, Society, National, Global

- Use Constitutional Articles
- Use Subheading - 3-4 = Quotes — Water Water
- 4-5 lines ka paragraph. Do not write 1-2 or 7-8 lines!
- Flow of the Essay — **Write masala in between Examples**. Add connectors sentences/words.
- 1 paragraph to each dimension.

Poems

> *Where the mind is without fear and the head is held high.*
> *Where knowledge is free Where the world has not been broken up into fragments By narrow domestic walls* ***Where words come out from the depth of truth***
> *..... my Father, let my country awake. -* ***Tagore****.*

> ***If this belief from heaven be sent,***
> ***If such be Nature's holy plan,***
> *Have I not reason to lament*
> *What man has made of man?*
> *— "Lines Written in Early Spring" —* ***William Wordsworth***

> *We Passed their grave;*
> *The dead man there,*
> *Winners or Losers,*
> *Did not care.*
> *In the dark*
> *They could not see*
> *Who had gained*
> *The Victory.*

> ***If - Rudyard Kipling***
>
> ***If you can keep your head when all about you***
> ***Are losing theirs and blaming it on you,***
> ***If you can trust yourself when all men doubt you,***
>
> ***If you can meet with Triumph and Disaster***
> ***And treat those two impostors just the same;***
>
> *If you can make one heap of all your winnings*
> *And risk it on one turn of pitch-and-toss,*

> ***Robert Frost's — "The Road not taken"***
>
> *"Two roads diverged in a wood, and I took the one less travelled by and that has made all the difference."*

> *Intro:* ***Poem 'Refugees' by Brian Bilston*** *- Top-Bottom,*
>
> *They have no need of our help*
> *So do not tell me...*
> *These haggard faces could belong to you or me*
> *Should life have dealt a different hand...'*

> *Samuel Coleridge's - The Rime of the Ancient Mariner*
>
> *Day after day; day after day*
> *We stuck, nor breath nor motion;*
> *As idle as a painted ship*
> *Upon a painted ocean.*
>
> *Water, water, every where,*
> *And all the boards did shrink;*
> *Water, water, every where,*
> *Nor any drop to drink.*

> ***A Psalm of Life - Henry Longfellow***
>
> ***Not enjoyment, and not sorrow,***
> ***Is our destined end or way;***
> ***But to act, that each to-morrow***
> ***Find us farther than to-day.***
>
> *Trust no Future, howe'er pleasant!*
> *Let the dead Past bury its dead!*

https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

> ***And lose, and start again at your beginnings***
> ***And never breathe a word about your loss;***
>
> ***If you can talk with crowds and keep your virtue,***
> ***Or walk with Kings—nor lose the common touch***
> *If neither foes nor loving friends* ***can hurt you,***
> ***If all men count with you****, but none too much;*
>
> *Yours is the Earth and everything that's in it,*
> *And—which is more—you'll be a Man, my son!*

> *Act,— act in the living Present!*
> *Heart within, and God o'erhead!*
>
> ***Lives of great men all remind us***
> ***We can make our lives sublime,***
> ***And, departing, leave behind us***
> ***Footprints on the sands of time;***

One Size Fits all

1. **We must never forget the past if we are to understand the present and focus on the future.**
    a. Start with contrasting 2 things - like Anudeep, Defence expenditure v/s poverty in India; NK vs SK
2. "You can't go back and change the beginning but **you can start where you are & change the ending" - C.S. Lewis**
3. '**We can** be **blind to the obvious**, but **we** are also **blind to our blindness'. – Nobel Laureate Daniel Kahneman**
4. Absence of Evidence is not a Evidence of Absence — Carl Sagan
5. As Victor Hugo said: **'No power on Earth can stop an idea whose time has come.'**
6. **Even a thousand mile journey has to start with first step - Mao Zedong**
7. India is a land of paradoxes —
8. Rawls - "Veil of ignorance" + 'Original position'
9. Some sigh sadly that '**India can't change in this aspect**'... But we must. Mahatma Gandhi did it. It will take a similar mass movement to deliver India its second freedom: freedom from *xyz*..
10. **Change does not roll in on the wheels of inevitability, but comes through continuous struggle - MLK Jr**
11. For any problem that *India is facing* - **Nehru's words from Tryst with Destiny speech**: *'We have hard work ahead. There is no resting for any one of us till we make all the people of India what destiny intended them to be.'*
12. A line from **Elvis Presley's song – 'A little less conversation, a little more action, please.'**
13. Sarve Bhavantu Sukhina (May all be Happy) Sarve Santu Niramaya (May all be without disease) //Sarve Bhadrani Pashyantu (May all have well-being) Maa Kaschit Dukh Bhagh Bhavet (May none have misery of any sort)//
14. We can't bury our head in sand and think that the problem will be solved. Need to face it head on.
15. **"If you can't fly then run, if you can't run then walk, if you can't walk then crawl, but whatever you do you have to keep moving forward." — Martin Luther King Jr. — Ethics Perseverance**
16. **"Given enough eyeballs, all bugs are shallow." - Linus Torvalds, Linux Founder**
17. As in the children's game of Chinese Whispers...
18. Martin Luther King, Jr. "We must learn to live together as brothers or perish together as fools."
19. *"XYZ will only be as strong as its weakest link".*
20. If a sheep leaves astray it is one thing but if the Shepard leaves, the whole herd is at danger.
21. We have seen so many **black swans & grey rhinos** that the very habitat has changed beyond recognition. — SJ MEA
22. Fundamental driver is **Darwin's theory**: survival of the fittest, domination of the strongest, **success** of the smartest and suffering of the weakest.
23. "Idealism not backed by power can be **self-defeating** and power not backed by ideas can be **blind**."

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

24. **The Achilles' heel is poor delivery.**
25. **The cobwebs of the past distort vision for future.**
26. **We need sense and sensibility, not pride and prejudice.**
27. **Harmony changes into dissonance and esoteric becomes cliche**
28. **Confucius** — 'Before you embark on a journey of *revenge*, dig two graves.'
29. "No man ever steps in the same river twice", "for it's not the same river and he's not the same man". - **Heraclitus**
30. To "strike a **Faustian bargain**" is to be willing to sacrifice anything to satisfy a limitless desire for power.
31. "The old will die and the young will forget".
32. *Seeing our place as part of the web of life, instead of at its centre, requires a Copernican shift in world views*
33. Beyond income, beyond averages, beyond today — HDI

Religion

Sanskrit Shlokas

- **Kritam me dakshine haste/jayo me svya aahita**. This means, if we have **action and duty** on one hand, then success is assured in the other hand.
- **Sheelam Param Bhushnam** - **Character is the highest virtue - Ethics**

Quran

- God will not change the condition of people until they bring about change themselves.

Mahabharat

- In many ways, Gandhari is the reason for the Mahabharata war. She chose to blindfold herself and so never really saw the truth about her children
- **Duryodhana's envy of the Pandava fortune is the root cause of the tragedy that is the Mahabharata. It is not that he has less but that his cousins have more that makes him suffer.**
- **Through Karna, Vyasa presents many conflicts of life: friendship or family, personal ambition or universal good, loyalty or opportunity**. This makes him the tragic figure of the Mahabharata, almost a Greek hero, striving single-handedly to create a place for himself in the world that rejects him. The Gladiator
- **The epic ends not with the victory of the Pandavas over the Kauravas but with Yudhishtira's triumph over himself.**
- Vijaya is material victory, where there is a loser. Jaya is spiritual victory, where there are no losers.
- **Yaksha Prashna in the Mahabharata of Yudhishtir taken by Yama (Lord of Death ~ Dharma ~ Yudhishtira's father)**
    - **'When is a man who is alive considered to be dead?' 'When he does not share his wealth with others'**
    - **'What is the greatest deed?' 'Non-violence.'**
    - **'What measures a man?' 'Conduct.'**
    - **'What is forgiveness?' 'Enduring the worst of enemies.'**
    - **'What is simplicity?' 'Equanimity.'**
    - **'What is the only thing man can conquer?' 'His own mind.'**
    - **'Who is man's most dreaded enemy?' 'Anger.'**
    - **'What is the worst disease?' 'Greed.'**

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

    - **‘How does one know the true path?’ ‘Reflect on one’s own life in silence and solitude.’**
- Through the story of Ram, Vyasa is trying to explain that while we believe our problems are the greatest and our misfortunes the worst, there is always someone out there who has suffered more.

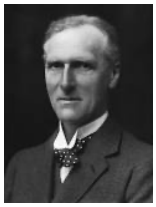
Agriculture

2.4 Sectors of Economy: Essay Topics





1. **Most things, except agriculture, can wait - J Nehru**
2. If agriculture fails everything else will fail. - MS Swaminathan
3. **The future belongs to nations which give importance to grains rather than guns. — MS Swaminathan**
4. **The discovery of agriculture was the first big step towards a civilised life.** - Arthur Keith, Anthropologist
5. **“You can't build a peaceful world on empty stomachs and human misery.”** - Norman Borlaug
6. **“The Farmer is the Only Man in Our Economy Who Buys Everything at Retail, Sells Everything at Wholesale, and Pays the Freight Both Ways.”**
7. “If the farmer is rich, then so is the nation.” - Amit Kalantri
8. Government is recognising the changing landscape of agricultural development. The **conferment of *Padma Shri* awards to 12 such farmer**-leaders in 2019 is a case in point.



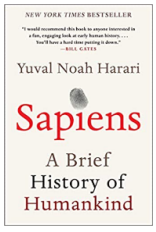


Intro — 1

“To a common wo/man, land is just a place where s/he works or resides. But for a farmer, its much more than that. It is -
L — Life
A — Ambition
N — Native
D — Determination
So the moment he loses his/her land, s/he loses everything.”

Intro — 2

- In his Book - **“Sapiens” — Yuval Noah Harari** remarks that “**Agricultural Revolution” is History’s biggest fraud. It revolutionised every one’s life — adding better diet and leisure — except that of a Farmer.**
- Rather than heralding a new era of easy living, the Agricultural revolution left farmers with lives **generally more difficult and less satisfying than those of Hunter-Gatherer. The Average farmer worked harder than average Hunter Gatherer and got a worse diet in return.**



Case Studies:

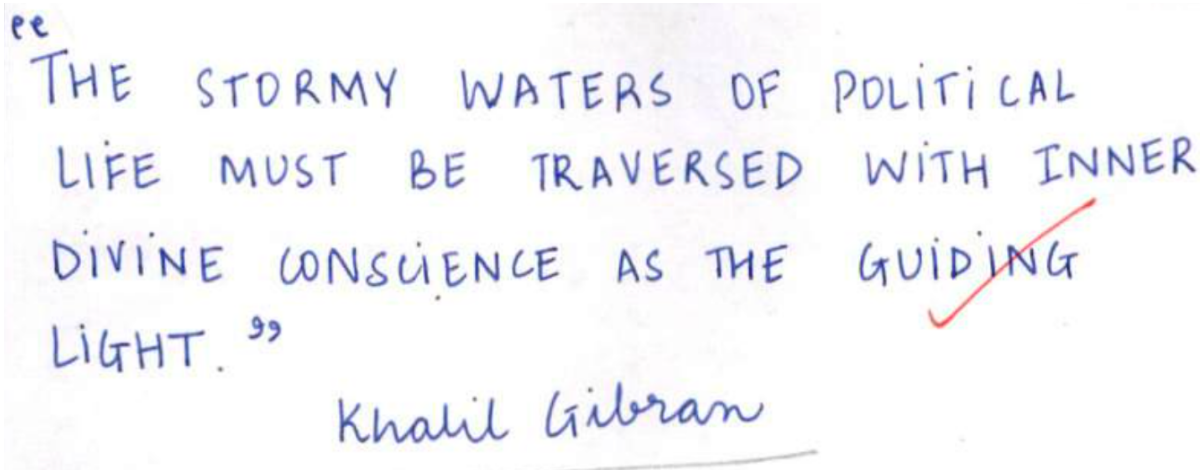
1. More than 35,000 farmers marched to Mumbai from Nashik in 2019 demanding loan waivers as well as the implementation of the Forest Rights Act (FRA).

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

2. Current Farmers protest against Farmers Bill — Government retracted the bill.
3. Farmers in **Andhra Pradesh** embraced the idea of integration of AI in assisting them to sow their crops. **What is the difference between a profitable year and failed harvest? It is timely information on the simple 'when to sow?'**, scientists of **ICRISAT & Engineers at Microsoft** joined forces to bring out an application that uses powerful cloud-based predictive analytics to arrive at a precise date for sowing.
4. KALIA, Rythu Bandhu, PM KISAN.
5. Indo-Israel Agriculture Project: India and Israel are set to jointly develop new crop varieties and share post accomplishments include growing **cherry tomatoes in Haryana, rejuvenating mango orchards in Maharashtra**
6. 38-year-old Kamalamma, a Class 10 passout, is now the richest woman in the tiny village in Karnataka - fondly known as '**Capsicum Kamalamma**'. In 2005, Kamalamma started a 'polyhouse' on a half- acre plot and today, she earns Rs **15 lakh annually** by growing and selling capsicum from this plot. With no academic background in agriculture, her interest in farming was supplemented by short term courses at the **Gandhi Krishi Vidya Kendra (GKVK) campus** of the University of Agricultural Sciences.

Civil Service, Administration, Politics, Corruption



1.3 Administration: Essay Topics

- Civil Service



1. "With bad laws and good **civil servants** it's still possible to govern. But with bad **civil servants** even the best laws can't help." - Otto Van Bismarck.
2. "After a time, **civil servants** tend to become no longer **servants** and no longer **civil**." — Winston Churchill
3. ***"Seva Parmo Dharma"*** — Service, in our Indian ethos, is the ultimate duty.



- IAS O P Chaudhary — Baster, 36gargh = **"Choolon Asman" and "Nanhe Parinde** despite death threats.
- IAS Saumya Pandey cut short her maternity leaves to serve the society during crisis
- **IAS Prashant Nair** - Compassionate Kozhikode (Home) and Operation Sulaiman (Food)
- IAS Kaustubh Diwegaonkar sat on floor to listen to the grievance of physically disabled man
- IAS Durga Shakti Nagpal against the land scam and sand mafia

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

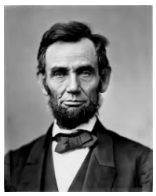
- IAS Armstrong Pame, who built road in spite of lack of government funding
- IAS Saurabh Sonawane, a doctor by training, started treating patients when there was shortage during Covid

- Politics





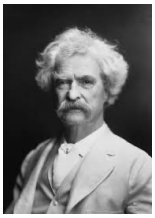
1. **Confucius** - Righteousness is the foundation stone of good governance.
2. Good governance should be like air. Its existence need not be discussed, but its absence would make a huge difference. — Pras Hanth.
3. Governance is not possible without assistance. A single wheel does not move the cart. — Chanakya
4. **Kautilya: — "In the happiness of his subjects lies his happiness, in their welfare his welfare".**
5. **Nearly all men can stand adversity, but if you want to test a man's character, give him power. - Lincoln**
6. A.G. Noorani, eminent constitutional lawyer - 'Despite their loud exchanges, political parties join hands against greater measures for accountability'.
7. Good Governance is **Demand Driven Process. (Amartya Sen, Habermas).**
8. Instead of "Good Gov" of Neo-liberals, **Sen calls for "Humane Gov"** + "Good Gov" i.e. in prior State acts as regulator and in later **State act as regulator + Capacity builder**.





- The concept of good governance has also emerged from **New Public Management** which began in the early 1980s, to improve public service efficiency.
- **INAM-Pro+** is a web-based platform and marketplace for infrastructure and material providers to conduct business in a fair, transparent and swift manner.
- **Padhe Dantewada Likhe Dantewada (PDLD)**

- Corruption

1. **The worst disease in the world today is corruption. And there is a cure: transparency.**
2. Shashi Tharoor – 'For the affluent, corruption is at worst a nuisance, for the salaried middle class, it can be a burden; **but for poor, it is tragedy.'**
3. Discussion on corruption many a times resembles what Mark Twain said about the **weather: "Everybody talks about it but nobody seems to be able to do something about it".**
4. Lord Acton's famous warning: 'Power tends to corrupt, and absolute power corrupts absolutely'
5. **Power doesn't corrupt people, people corrupt power.**
6. **Broken window theory** - Malcolm Gladwell in '*The Tipping Point*' — We need to **tackle corruption cases at lowest and**




https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

petty level. **eg - Anna Hazare bhajan in corrupt official district.**

7. In "*Arthshastra*" Kautilya says that the **Mahamatras** (the bureaucrats of his time) are like fish in water. It is difficult to find out when fish is drinking.

Examples: →





1. **Eichemann in Jerusalem (Hannah Arendt) — Problem with Bureaucrat working blindly without conscience**.
2. **Lant Pritchett** - for India - **"Failing state syndrome"** - a nation-state in which the head, that is elite institutions remains sound and functional but **is no longer reliably connected via nerves and its own limbs**.
3. **Milan Vaishnav** - Pop-culture mockery - from **'Ji Mantriji' to 'Office Office' - Mussadilal, a common man**, struggles to get his work done at various government offices amid rampant corruption and inefficiency. Reflection of unpopular perception of Indian administration.
4. TN Sheshan (Bas Naam hi kafi hai)





Conclusion:



1. If we want to make things happen, we must first have a belief that they can happen. There are people who believe that it is difficult to change mindset of old but we should remember the **optimistic message of Rajaji - charcoal, graphite, diamond - are diff. forms of carbon - depending on circumstances**, then how much great is the potential of human - as they are **sentient**.
2. "Every saint has a past and every sinner has a future". — Oscar Wilde
3. Work towards corruption free India. Many may feel helpless but remember the eternal call of **Kathopanishad** which Vivekananda used to invoke - **Arise, Awake and Stop-not till the goal is reached.**



Constitution & Democracy

1.1 India Since Independence: Essay Topics

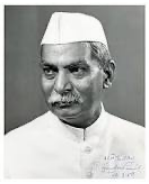
Constitution:

> *Intro Idea: — The world marvels at how well the Indian Constitution has kept a diverse country together for more than 70 years. the Constitution's long history stretches to over 40 years before its enactment, going all the way back to the Indian Councils Act of 1909. This law, for the first time, brought Indians into governance at central and provincial levels.*

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/





1. “If I find the constitution being misused, I shall be the first to burn it.” - Ambedkar
2. ***“A Constitution like a machine is a lifeless thing. It acquires life because of the men who control it and operate it” — Rajendra Prasad***
3. ‘Constitution is not a monolithic entity but an organic entity that evolves over time’. — Nehru
4. **“Let us examine if the Constitution has failed us or we have failed the Constitution.” — Prez Narayan**
5. **Jean Jacques Rousseau** said a long time back, “the strongest is never strong enough to be always master **unless he transform his power into right, and obedience into duty”**.
6. The American civil rights activist Jesse Jackson said, ‘Deliberation and debate is the way you stir the soul of our democracy.’





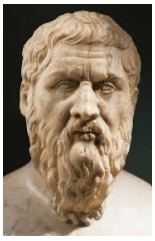
Democracy:

> ***Intro Idea (1)***: — ***Story of Indian going as Tourist to another*** *(non democratic) country and finding that things that s/he had taken for granted by the virtue of being in a Democratic Country, are dreams for many people in such countries.*

- In **Saudi Arabia** women do not have the right to vote.
- In **Fiji**, the electoral system is such that the vote of an indigenous Fiji has more value than that of an Indian-Fijian.







1. “The best argument against democracy is a five-minute conversation with the average voter.” - Churchill
2. “**The ballot is stronger than the bullet.” - Abraham Lincoln**
3. **“The price good men pay for indifference to public affairs is to be ruled by evil men.” - Plato**
4. “My **notion of democracy** is that under it the weakest should have the same opportunity as the strongest” - Gandhi
5. “Government exists for the interests of the governed, not for the governors.” - Thomas Jefferson
6. “Democracy in India is only a **top-dressing** on an Indian soil which is essentially undemocratic.” - Ambedkar
7. **As per Amartya Sen, a nation is not 'fit for democracy', rather it becomes fit through democracy.**









> *Democracy, as we know it today, has developed over a long period of time, **drawing on different kinds of experiences and experiments**. **Ancient Greece (6th cent. BC)** - involving minority. Piecemeal attempts elsewhere as well as democratic **local governance - India, Persia and Bactria (2000 years ago)**. ‘Constitution of 17 articles’ promulgated in **Japan in AD 604** - insisted on the need for wide consultation for decision taken by the state. Democracy in present form - **English Magna Carta in 1215, FR and AR (18th cent.),** to the spread of franchise.*

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

Examples: —





1. **Book: — "India after Gandhi" - Guha** - divides history into several distinct period - first two decades - **constitutional democracy and followed by 'populist' democracy.**
2. **Book: — "Uncertain Glory" — Sen** - points to many undemocratic acts -
   a. **Sheikh Abdullah incarcerated in 1953 for a decade**
   b. **Kashmir and AFSPA.**
   c. **Suppression of the independence mov. in Nagaland**
   d. **Removing of Kerala gov. in pretext of law & order** situation.

PRIs



> *Intro: **1950s** → **State introduced PRIs (Nehru at Nagore, RJ).** **Panchayati Raj**, the institutional manifestation of **Democratic Decentralisation** in India, became an integral part of Constitution with 73rd CAA - 1993 + **Article 40.***
>
> *Amartya Sen (Book: **Argumentative Indian**): Rig Veda provides evidence that even around 1700 BCE, self-governing bodies called 'sabhas' existed!*





1. Ambedkar: → Centralised Approach. Villages as "**Dens of Ignorance**"
2. **"Local self-government is the life blood of liberty" – John Motley.**
3. When the panchayat raj is established, public opinion will do what violence can never do." — Mahatma Gandhi
4. Gandhi's Oceanic Circle of Power..
5. Gandhi's call from **Gramoday to Rashtroday**.
6. **"Ashok Mehta Committee"** - 1977 → **Panchayat, a God that failed**. Why?
7. **"Mani Shankar Iyer Committee" - 2012** → Bad Panchayat is worse than No Panchayat.
   a. **"Decentralisation of Corruption"**
8. Elango Ramaswamy - "Network Economy"
9. Ela Bhaat — 100 mile radius = Self sufficient radius..





Examples:

- Cyber-savvy **Chhavi Rajawat** of Soda village, RJ
- **Sushma Bhadu** of Dhani Miyan Khan village in Haryana - ***Zero Dropout, Best Sex Ratio***.
- **Kerela, in 1996, gave 40% of its budget to panchayats** which improved the situation to a great extent, but despite the efforts there were still some problems.

Case studies:

1. **Hivare Bazaar - Maharashtra — Popat Rao Pawar** — Panchayat = Own five years plans. Community participation.

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

a. 1990s —
    i. 168/180 families below poverty.
    ii. Water scarcity + Droughts
b. Today —
    i. 0 family below poverty — It is India's richest village.
    ii. No Mosquito + ODF.

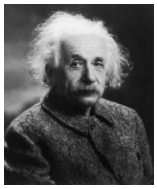
2. **Dharnai village near Bodh Gaya in Bihar. It didn't have access to electricity.** But a few years ago, with the resolve of Gram Panchayats, the village installed a **solar-powered micro-grid**, which provides 24×7 electricity to more than 450 households and 50 commercial establishments - making Dharnai **India's first fully solar powered village.**

Disaster Management/COVID-19

1.3 Administration: Essay Topics

> ***Intro idea for Climate Change and COVID-19 (1): —*** *XYZ crisis is not a **'black swan.' It's a 'gray rhino'** (Reference **Nicholas Taleb's book**) and go on to explain how we as humans have failed to see the pandemic and how our actions are detrimental to the planet)*







1. It is not the Earthquake that kills, its the buildings.
2. **In the midst of every crisis, lies great opportunity - Albert Einstein**
    a. England saw its last **major outbreak of bubonic plague in 1665-66**. As a precautionary measure, the students at **Cambridge University, including young Newton**, were sent home till the following year. He spent his enforced vacation working on ideas underlying his *spectacular accomplishments: gravitation, laws of motion, calculus, and optics".*
3. What's true of all the evils in the world is true of plague as well. It helps men to rise above themselves. - Albert Camus
4. In the words of **Stanford historian Walter Scheidel, pandemics are one of the "four horsemen"** that have flattened inequality. The other three are ***wars, revolutions and state failures.***
5. There are decades when nothing happens and then there are weeks where decades happens. — Lenin





> ***Conclusion****: "And once the storm is over, you won't remember how you made it through, how you managed to survive. You won't even be sure, whether the storm is really over. But one thing is certain. When you come out of the storm, you won't be the same person who walked in. That's what this storm is all about" - **Haruki Murakami, in 'Kafka on the Shore'***



Education

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

3 Education: Essay Topics

Education is derived from the Latin word "***Educatio***" which means "to raise" that is to bring out best of quality in the child.

> ***Intro idea (1)****: Two countries separated by 38th Parallel. Contrast North Korea and South Korea and mention the progress that South Korea has with eighth focus on education — South Korea — Independence in 1947. Was lagging behind India in all socio-economic indicators. In* ***1959*** *the gov. gave a call for universal education. Focused on skill based learning, and within 5 year whole SK was literate.*







1. In a powerful diagnosis, Tagore said: '**Imposing tower of misery which rests on India has its sole foundation in the absence of education**'.
2. "Education is the most powerful weapon you can use to change the world." - **Nelson Mandela**
3. "Live as if you were to die tomorrow. Learn as if you were to live forever." - **Mahatma Gandhi**
4. "Educating the mind without educating the heart is no education at all." - **Aristotle**
5. "Children must be taught how to think, not what to think." — **Margaret Mead**
6. **True quality does not come from a great building or great facilities. It happens when education is imparted with love by great teachers. — APJ Abdul Kalam**







Examples:

1. **Meiji restoration, 1868** - Japan had higher level of literacy than Europe, even though it had not yet undergone IR. Fundamental code of Education, 1872 - **'no community with an illiterate family, nor a family with illiterate person'.** Rapid economic growth due to market economics rightly emphasized. But, that process was greatly helped by **achievement in public education.**
2. **Amartya Sen - women literacy leads to their well being**. Eg. -1990s - **Dharmapuri - rural literacy drive, Kerala.**
3. ***"Taliban"* meaning Student.**
4. **Rwanda - mid-1990s - genocides**. Children "social soil" to grow national identity and prevent ethnic clash. Gov. used a national curriculum to help create a new national identity. Contained elements of myths, values and symbols.
5. Suicide of Aishwarya Reddy (19), a 2nd-year student of LSR college due to financial hardships.

Environment/Sust. Dev

2.2 Environment vs Development: Essay Topics

> *Intro idea (1): —* ***Three shifts in natural resource*** *use have taken place in the last 400 years: from agriculture to industry; rural to urban; and, livelihood to well-being. Colonialism was the driver of the first shift, infrastructure of the second, and societal notions of progress of the third.*

> *Intro idea (2): — Two drastic scenario — 1. Cyclone swept away home, livelihoods along with dreams of some girl living in Coastal area 2. Delay in Monsoon lead to early loss of Father, of a son, whose father was unable to pay debt.*

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/







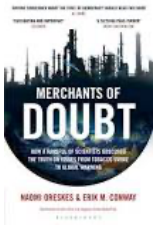




1. **'The greatest threat to our planet is the belief that someone else will save it.' — Robert Swan, 1st person to walk both the North and South Poles)**
2. *What is common to the greatest number gets the least amount of care. - Aristotle (Tragedy of Common — Elenor Ostrom)*
3. **"We are the first generation to feel the effect of climate change and the last generation who can do something about it." — President Obama**
4. 'There is no Plan B because there is no Planet B' – Ban-ki-Moon
5. **We're in a giant car heading towards a brick wall and everyone's arguing over where they're going to sit.**
6. **We do not inherit the earth from our ancestors, we borrow it from our children.**
7. Someone is sitting in the shade today because someone planted a tree a long time ago.
8. "The greatness of a nation can be judged by the way its animals are treated." - Gandhi
9. "The world has enough for everyone's need but not enough for everyone's greed."- Gandhi
10. **"If you think the economy is more important than the environment, try holding your breath while counting your money". — Guy Mcpherson**

> *Conclusion: **Seeing our place as part of the web of life, instead of at its centre, requires a Copernican shift in world views**. Just as Copernicus changed the perception of the earth from the centre of the universe to being one among many planets*

Examples: →







1. **Book - "Merchants of Doubt" - "Tobacco strategy"** - **hire some scientist to discredit scientific evidence** that smoking causes cancer - "**to keep the controversy alive**". Same strategy in climate change. These arguments are cited by media, leaders for their inaction even when these scientist don't have any original scientific research to prove.
2. **Book: - "The Uninhabitable earth" - David Wallace - 5 five mass extinctions experienced - all but one that killed the dinosaurs involved climate change produced by GHGs.**
3. **"Sleepwalking into ecological disaster" — WEF** said in its Global Risks Report.
    a. *Climate refugees (UN 200 mn by 2050)*
    b. *Great Pacific garbage patch*
    c. *Australian and California wildfire*
    d. *Air pollution - Delhi - players using mask for playing cricket + 2 packet cigarette equivalent*
    e. *Zero water day in Cape Town*
    f. *Thawing of Permafrost* → 20,000 tonne Oil leaked in Arctic region power plant of Russia.
4. Tulsi Gowda, a 72 year old environmentalist, collected her Padma Shri award barefooted + From Karnataka + had planted more than **30,000 saplings + k/a 'Encyclopedia of Forest"**
5. Kautilya's Arthashastra suggested various penalties for tree fellers and animal

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

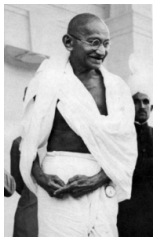
https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

poachers.

Ethics

4 Quote based, Philosophy, Ethics: Essay Topics

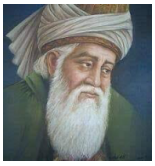
1. **Kritam me dakshine haste/jayo me svya aahita**. This means, if we have **action and duty** on one hand, then success is assured in the other hand.
2. **Sheelam Param Bhushnam** - **Character is the highest virtue - Ethics**



Gandhi

1. **“The best way to find yourself is to lose yourself in the service of others.”**
2. “Happiness is when what you think, what you say and what you do are in harmony.”
3. **“First they ignore you, then they laugh at you, then they fight you, then you win”**
4. “Satisfaction lies in the effort, not in the attainment. Full effort is full victory.”
5. “A man is but the product of his thoughts. What he thinks, he becomes.”
6. “The weak can never forgive. Forgiveness is the attribute of the strong.” (Eva Kor)
7. Beliefs → Thoughts → Words → Actions → Habits → Values → Destiny.











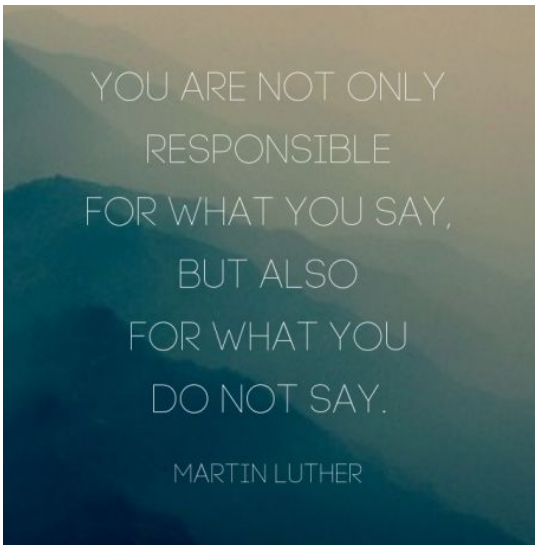
- ***“It is our choices, Harry, that show what we truly are, far more than our abilities,"*** *- Albus Dumbledore in 'Harry Potter And Chamber Of Secrets'.*
- “**Out beyond the ideas of right-doing and wrongdoing, there is a field I will meet you there.**” — Rumi
- If there were only one truth, you couldn’t paint a hundred canvases on the same theme. - **Pablo Picasso.**
- **“Tolerance has never provoked a civil war; intolerance has covered the Earth in carnage”. - Voltaire**
- **“Truth exists in absolute form which cannot be eclipsed by blinkers of prejudices**. — Kovind
- **Honesty is the first chapter in the book of wisdom.**
- If you tell the truth, you don't have to remember anything. - Mark Twain



- Three ways to learn wisdom: —
  - i. First, by reflection, which is noblest.
  - ii. Second, by imitation, which is easiest;
  - iii. And third, by experience, which is the bitterest.

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/





Examples: →







1. **Whistle-blower doctor Li Wenliang - died.**
2. **Thomas Paine** had been tried for treason in England in **1792** for his book "**Rights of Man**". **Thomas Erskine, Attorney General for the Prince of Wales**, was warned of dismissal if he defended Paine, but still took up the brief, saying: "… If the advocate refuses to defend from what he may think of the charge or of the defence, he assumes the character of the Judge…"
3. Bhageerathi Amma, 105 - passed the Class IV literacy equivalent examinations.
4. Sporting Moments:
    a. **XIA Boyu** — **In his first attempt to climb Mt. Everest he lost his both legs but not his determination.** He tried three more times later but could not succeed. But in **2018 in his 5th attempt** he succeeded, becoming the first person to scale Mt. Everest being an amputee from Nepal Side.
    b. Brownlee Brothers — British runner Alistair Brownlee (Older) gave up his chance at first place at **World Triathlon Series in 2016 Mexico** by stopping to help carry his younger brother over the finish line
    c. **Karoly T - Left-handed Right hand shooter 😎 (1948-1952)**







Free Speech

1.7 Media, TV & Cinema: Essay Topics

1. "I do not agree with what you have to say, but I'll defend to the

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

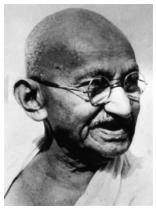


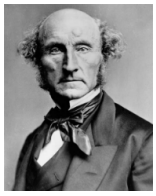




death your right to say it." — **Evelyn Beatrice Hall in book (*The Friends of Voltaire)***

2. Thomas Jefferson — "***I will prefer free press and no government rather than government without free press***"
3. *Martin Luther King, Jr.: "**Our lives begin to end the day we become silent about things that matter.**"*
4. *Dissent is safety valve of democracy — Justice DYC.*
5. ***There is no thing as 'voiceless', there are only the deliberately silenced, or the preferably unheard.***
6. I want the **culture of all lands to be blown** about my house as freely as possible. But I refuse to be **blown off my feet by any**". — Gandhi
7. In the words of **Mill**, — "If all but one has a difference of opinion, all should listen to that person, just like we will not accept the tyranny of one over 'all' we can not accept the tyranny of all over one".
8. Censorship is saying - 'I'm the one who says the last sentence'.





Examples:

1. Gramsci - Revolution took place in semi-feudal Russia but not Western countries because Russia directly and unashamedly exercised brute power. Civil society acts as vent to let out anger without revolt.
2. Article 19 of UN UDHR, our constitution - need to defend free speech.
3. Public order, sedition, obscenity and pornography, hate speech, film and internet censorship, defamation, privacy, contempt of court, surveillance, net neutrality, copyrights. Salman Rushdie and Wendy Doniger. Shreya Singhal. Khashoggi.

Federalism

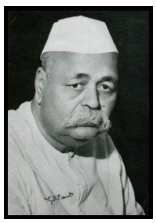
1.2 Federalism, Decentralisation: Essay Topics

> *Intro Idea (1): An early successful historical example of federalism is the **Achaean League in Hellenistic Greece**. Unlike the Greek city states of Classical Greece, each of which insisted on keeping its complete independence, Achaean League choose to be a **federal state even at the cost of losing part of their sovereignty** - similar to the process leading to the formation of today's federations (Eg. India. USA). **It was successful as it balanced the need for collective action with the desire for local autonomy.***





1. *Federalism* is a ***political contravene*** among those who **desire *utility without uniformity. - Dicey.***
2. ***Mark Twain*: *Whiskey is to drink as water is to fight.*** South Asia is water stressed primarily due to agrarian nature of the economy. Future Wars for Water, the new oil.
3. **"Anyone who can solve the problems of water will be worthy of two Nobel prizes - one for science and one for peace." - John F. Kennedy**



https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/



4. River knows no linguistic boundaries. — **G. B. Pant**
5. India's Constitution establishes a form of asymmetric federalism, in which some States enjoy greater autonomy over governance than others. — *Louise Tillin*
6. **PM**: "Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas"



> *Conclusion: — The question is whether the **whole is greater than the parts** or the **parts** are going to **determine the future** of the **whole.***

- Bundle of sticks — Unity in Diversity.

Examples: →

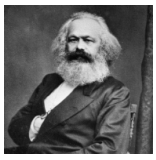
1. Para-diplomacy : When CG involves SG in Foreign Policy Formulation.
    a. Eg. Russia Far East Business Summit.
    b. Chhattisgarh and Telangana in Talona dialogue.
2. Theoretical (Cliched) examples:
        i. RS seats (USA - 2, India - Different)
        ii. Special category states - Taxation and fund devolution patterns
        iii. NE states - Art 371
        iv. 5th and 6th Schedule.
3. Recent cracks in Federalism — Legislative Assembly of Kerala passing a resolution against CAA indicates that ***opposition is being shifted from Opposition in Parliament to State Government themselves.***

Globalisation

6.1 Globalization: Essay Topics

2.3 MNCs: Essay Topics

"Borderless World": KO || "Global Village": Marshall



> *Adding **Definition** to a Intro: Globalisation is an **inexorable integration of markets, nations states and technology** to a degree never witnessed before. - **Thomas Friedman** (Book: **The World is Flat)***

1. "Search for profits will take bourgeois everywhere..." - **Marx**
2. **Kofi Annan had said, arguing against globalisation is like arguing against the laws of gravity.**
3. **"Essentially, globalisation went from being a means for national economic prosperity to becoming the end" — Dani Rodrik (Book: Straight talk on trade)**
4. Post Cold War era marks the **End of Geography** manifested by Globalisation rather than the End of History (Ramesh Thakur and Jörge Heine)
5. Prakash Bhanu Mehta (*as Conclusion*): Globalisation is an **ethical impulse**. It creates enormous possibilities for societies but if not handled properly, it is nothing more than **new pastures for elites.**





> *Conclusion: Yet, while globalisation isn't perfect, it has pulled millions out of poverty in developing countries like China and India, created new markets for goods made by poor*

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

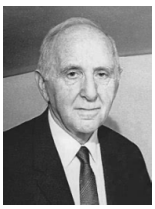
> *countries, and reduced prices for rich-country consumers. The* ***economic and cultural backlash must be resisted, and the promise of global integration realised for all.***

Examples: —

1. Reverse globalisation/De-globalisation refers to a trend of several countries are taking **protectionist measures** and adopting such economic and trade policies that put their national interests first
2. Globalisation - De-Globalisation Cycles: — **Thomas Friedman**
    a. First wave - 1850-1914. Trade reached 40% of global GDP by 1914.
    b. First Reverse wave — 1914-1945 — By 1945 Trade dropped to 7% of Global GDP - isolationist policies.
    c. Second wave - 1990 - Demise of Soviet.
    d. Roots of current Second reverse wave — 2008 financial crisis + COVID-19 final nail.
3. **Butterfly effect - Butterfly wing flutter in Amazon - Edward Lorenz** for weather prediction - can be used i
4. Problems —
    a. COVID
    b. 2008 crisis
    c. Communalism
5. Jules Verne's — "***Around the World in 80 days***" has ceased to be glorious adventure and has become Banal.

Growth & Development

2.1 Growth vs Development: Essay Topics

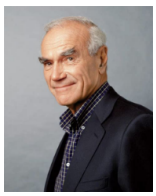






1. **Kuznets** - **"Welfare of a nation can scarcely be inferred from a measurement of national income as defined by the GDP"**
2. **Adam Smith**'s 'invisible hand' would suddenly be more visible, and be skewed towards a direction of focusing on well-being.
3. ***"Development is about transforming lives of people, not just transforming economies."*** - Joseph Stiglitz.
4. ***Our three way fast lane of LPG must provide safe pedestrian crossings for the unempowered India****. - President K. R. Narayan*
5. "Economic growth without investment in Human development is unsustainable and unethical." - Sen
6. "**Entrenched** power structure can **frustrate enlightened reforms**". — **William H. Uraper**
7. "It is **idle mendicancy to discard our Own and beg for the foreign", while, at the same time "it is the abjectness of poverty to dwarf ourselves by rejecting the foreign".** — **Rabindranath Tagore**







Data/Instances:

1. The so-called **'Asian experience'**, beginning with Japan in the late 19th cent., the SK, Taiwan, Singapore and now

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

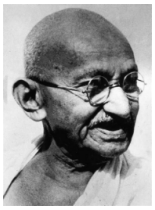
https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

China, has been based on a skillful use of complementarity of economic expansion and human advancement through education, health-care, better nutrition. - **Sen's 'Uncertain Glory'**

2. Measures of economic development - GNH, Green GDP, Gender Inequality Index, HDI. Qualitative improvement in std. of living with growth.
3. HDR 2019: "**Beyond income, beyond averages, beyond today":** Inequalities in human development in 21st century"

Health

1.5 Poverty, Social Justice: Essay Topics





1. Gandhi: '**It is health that is real wealth and not pieces of gold and silver**'.
2. Amartya Sen remark - **Indian healthcare represents islands of California in a sea of sub-Saharan Africa.**
3. Healthy citizens are the greatest asset any nation can have. - Winston Churchill
4. An Ounce of prevention is worth a Pound of cure - Benjamin Franklin
5. Vedic texts say - '**Arogyam Paraman Bhagyam**' - Good health is the greatest blessing.
6. **"Sarve Bhavantu Sukhinah, Sarve Santu Niramayah"** – It means "May All become Happy, May All be Healthy" — Upanishads
7. Vishwa Vaidya, HCQ, 'Good samaritan', **'Pharmacy of world'** - Generic medicine, Yoga + COVID19 Vaccines given to 150+ Countries





Successful examples of healthcare —



1. **Dr. Shetty — Narayana Health** — Use economies of scale to complete heart surgeries at a lower cost ($1500) than in US (~$100,000) — "**the Henry Ford of heart surgery**" + Bypasswale Baba. Performs 30 Surgeries a day in comparison to standard practice of 1 or 2 in western countries.
2. Temporal - Combined many concepts such as ***diet, climate, beliefs, supernatural, empirical, and culture into treatment of the person - Holistic 'One Health'***. *Atharva Veda, Charaka, Sushruta, Yoga, prevention rather than cure.*
3. Against Privatisation (Crisis Angle): — 80% doctors and 64% beds are in the private sector, clinics have closed down and private hospitals have stepped back fearing infections.
4. Mohalla clinics model
5. Odisha e-healthcare
6. Kerala Model

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

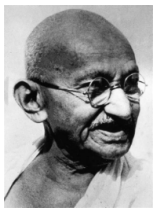
https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

Hunger

1.5 Poverty, Social Justice: Essay Topics

Data:

- GHI 2019: 102/117 (From 95 in 2010) [Welthungerhilfe]
- People facing acute food insecurity could double this year to 265 million due to economic fallout of COVID19, WFP.
- Malnutrition affects cognitive ability, workforce days and health, impacting as much as **16% of GDP** (WFP + WB).



1. Hunger is the worst weapon of mass destruction. It claims millions of victims each year.
2. “There are people in the world, so hungry, that God cannot appear to them except in the form of bread.” - **Gandhi**.
3. “Give a bowl of rice to a man and you will feed him once. Teach him how to grow his own rice and you feed him for life.” — **Confucius**
4. Henry Dunant (Founder: Red Cross): “**Our real enemy is not the neighbouring country; it is h*unger, poverty, and prejudice***.”
5. **South-Asian Enigma** - high level of under-nutrition in South-Asia compared with many sub-Saharan African countries that have poorer income and health indicators.



> ***Conclusion**: In his speech - **'Freedom at midnight', Nehru** mentioned, "The ambition of the greatest men of our generation has been to wipe every tear from every eye. That may be beyond us, but as long as there are tears and suffering, so long our work will not be over."*

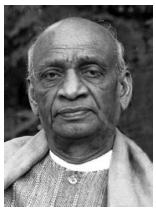
India

1 India: Democracy, administration, Society, Culture: Essay Topics

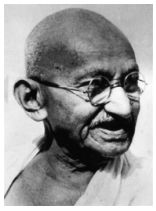




> *Where the mind is without fear and the head is held high.*
> *Where knowledge is free Where the world has not been broken up into fragments*
> *By narrow domestic walls Where words come out from the depth of truth*
> *..... my Father, let my country awake. - **Rabindranath Tagore**.*



1. India should walk on her own shadow - we must have our own developmental model - **Kalam**.
2. “**By common endeavor we can raise the country to a new greatness, while a lack of unity will expose us to fresh calamities**.” - **Sardar Patel**
3. **Gandhi** saw India’s independence as an opportunity to “***wipe every tear from every eye***”.



> ***Firaq**:*
> *“Sar zamine Hind par (On the soil of Hindustan)*
> *Aqwaame Aalam ke Firaq (O Firaq Caravans from all over the world)*

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

> *Qaafile baste gaye (Kept coming)*
> *Hindostan banta gayaa. (And so was Hindustan made).*

> *2019: FM Sitharaman ended this colonial practice by presenting the budget in a traditional **four-fold red cloth ledger**.*

Caste

1.5 Poverty, Social Justice: Essay Topics







1. Caste is a social custom that **all our great preachers have tried to break**. — Vivekananda
2. Nehru (Tryst with Destiny) → 'We cannot encourage communalism, for no **nation can be great whose people are narrow** in thought or in action.'
3. **'Why National Fail' — Robinson and Acemoglu** - **Rigid hereditary caste system limited the functioning of markets and allocation of labour.**
4. **Hindu society is like a tower, each floor of which is allotted to one caste with no staircase. The floor on which one is born is also the floor on which one dies.**
5. Caste is not just a division of labour, it is a **division of labourers** - Baba
6. **Diane McWhorter — "To sanitise the language of segregation is to mute its destructive force."**
7. Credit of Success of Indian Democracy to Caste — Rajni Kothari



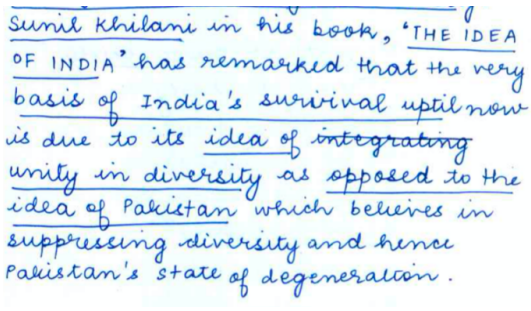




*Ambedkar - **Educate, agitate and organise.***

Pluralism

1.6 Indian Society, Culture and Values: Essay Topics



Facts and Examples:

- Number of languages spoken in India by more than 10,000 people = **121** as per Census 2011, and **270** mother tongues. (more nationalistic statement — **India is home to 1618 languages and dialect)**
- India - 5000 year old civilisation. 6 major religions
- **Shabnam Bano from MP - first ever transgender to be elected to public office (as an MLA) in 1998.**

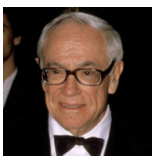
1. If America is famously a **'melting pot',** then to me **India is a**

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/







thali, a selection of sumptuous dishes in different bowls which do not belong together but **complement each other.** — **Shashi Tharoor.**

2. **"Diversity is not how we differ. Diversity is about embracing one another's uniqueness".** — **Ola Joseph**
3. Diversity: the art of thinking independently together. - **Malcolm Forbes**
4. Justice is art of differentiations rather than Science of Homogenisation. - Walzer.
5. **Where the world has not been broken up into fragments - By narrow domestic walls — Tagore**
6. **Diversity may be the hardest thing for a society to live with, but perhaps the most dangerous thing to live without** - **William Sloane Coffin Jr.**







> *During the **war with Pakistan in 1971**, when the Pakistani leadership proclaimed a jihad against the Hindu unbelievers, the Indian Air Force in the northern sector was commanded by a **Muslim (Later Air Chief Marshal, Latif);** the army commander was a **Parsi (Later Field Marshal Manekshaw)**, the general officer commanding the forces that marched into Bangladesh was a **Sikh (General Arora)**, and the general flown in to negotiate the surrender of the Pakistani forces in East Bengal was **Jewish (Major-General Jacob)**. They led the armed forces of an overwhelmingly Hindu country. That is '**India**'.*

> *It was not surprising that when Doordarshan broadcast a fifty-two-episode serialisation of the Mahabharata, the script **was written by a Muslim, Dr Rahi Masoom Raza.***

International Relations

6 International issues, Internal Security: Essay Topics

1. **"There are no permanent friends or foes in diplomacy; there are only permanent interests"** — Henry Kissinger
2. "Let us sweat in peace, not bleed in war". - **V. Pandit**
3. Machiavelli's advice: "Clever like Fox, Brave like Lion".
4. "Prisoners in Dilemma" + "Game of Chicken".
5. Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam
6. In the information age it's not enough to be the bigger army or the larger economy, **it's the land of the better story that prevails.** (Soft Power)
7. The World listens to the argument of Power and not to power of the argument.
8. The world must learn to work together, or finally it will not work at all. - **Dwight**

https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/

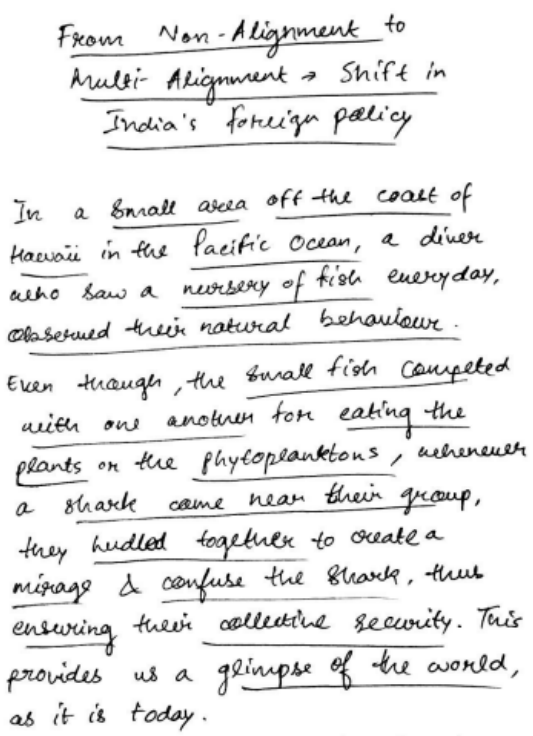
https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

Eisenhower

9. **Foreign policy is a matter of costs and benefits, not theology. - Fareed Zakaria.**
10. Robert Kaplan: “A state’s values are not just part of its foreign policy, but they are **paramount to it.**”

Instances that can drive home the points: —

- September 11 and global security
- Fall of the Berlin Wall
- Global financial crisis 2007–09
- The Rio ‘Earth Summit’
- The birth of the nuclear era.



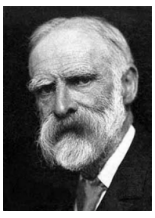
India and Neighbourhood:

1. **The connections are centuries old. The lines on the maps, though, are just 70 years old.**
2. Good fences make good neighbours
3. You can change friends but not neighbours. — Atal Bihari Vajpayee
4. If goods don't cross border soldiers will.

Judiciary

1.4 Judiciary: Essay Topics

Yatho Dharma Thatho Jayaha





1. “There is **no better test** of the excellence of the Govt. than the Functioning of its Judicial System” — Lord Byrce.
2. **At his best, man is the noblest of all animals; Separated from LAW AND JUSTICE, he is the worst. – Aristotle.**
3. **Injustice anywhere is threat to Justice Everywhere. — ML King Jr**
4. '**The role of the judiciary is to be an alarm clock, not a time keeper**' - Nani Palkhiwala.
5. Pen is mightier than Sword. A Judge’s Pen is mightier than anybody else’s Pen!





> *Conclusion: If the **lamp of Justice** goes off, it will be difficult to imagine the amount of darkness.*

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/

Examples: —

1. **H R Khanna — ADM Jabalpur Dissent and losing Chief Justiceship**.
2. V. R. Krishna Iyer — The founder of Public Interest Litigation and the liberal expansion of locus standi — hailed as "Chief Justice of the People's Court of India"

Leader/Personality

4.1 Character, Honesty, Ethics: Essay Topics

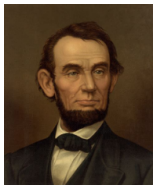


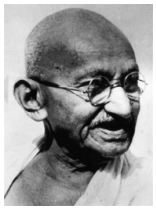




1. Ambition is *refusing to quit* on ourselves. *Leadership is refusing to quit on others* — Simon Sinek.
2. **"Whatever action an inspirational entity performs, the world follows the same." - Bhagawad Gita**
3. Management is climbing the ladder of success, Leadership is making sure that it is leaning towards the right wall.
4. Leadership is communicating other's worth and potential so clearly that they are inspired to see it in themselves. — Steven Covey
5. Attitude of a leader – **"Success is Yours, Failure is Mine".**
6. **The man who moves a mountain begins by carrying away small stones.**
7. **"Take the first step in faith. You don't have to see the whole staircase." Martin Luther King.**
8. **The Best way to destroy an enemy is to him/her a friend. — Lincoln**
9. **Non coop with evil is as much a duty as is coop with good. — Gandhi**







Examples: —







1. In 1979, When SLV-3 failed under the directorship of APJ Abdul Kalam, Satish Dhawan (Head of ISRO) took the front stage in the conference. When in 1980, ISRO succeeded, Satish Dhawan said to APJ Abdul Kalam **'You go and conduct the press conference.'**
2. Stephen Hawking one of the greatest minds in human history survived debilitating physical condition.
3. T.N. Seshan, Chief Election Commissioner during 1990-96, had initiated a process of cleaning the electoral system. It changed the face of democracy
4. Satyendra Dubey was a Project Director at **NHAI revealed huge financial irregularities in projects** and misuse of public funds. Lost his life.
5. Manjunath Shanmugam exposed corruption in public





https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

organisations at the cost of his lives. Such brave acts led to Whistle blowers act in 2012.



When the great revolutionary writer Thomas Paine was jailed and tried for treason in England in 1792 for writing his famous pamphlet `**The Rights of Man**' in defence of the French Revolution the great advocate Thomas Erskine was briefed to defend him. Erskine was at that time the **Attorney General for the Prince of Wales** and he was warned that if he accepts the brief, he would be dismissed from office. Undeterred, Erskine accepted the brief and was dismissed from office.



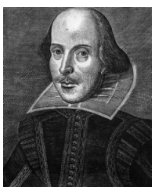
However, his immortal words in this connection stand out as a shining light even today: —

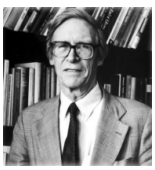
> *"From the moment that any advocate can be permitted to say that he will or will not stand between the Crown and the subject arraigned in court where he daily sits to practice, from that moment the liberties of England are at an end.* ***If the advocate refuses to defend from what he may think of the charge or of the defence, he assumes the character of the Judge.***

Liberty/Individuality

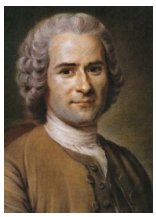
[No Corresponding Topic Found]







1. **“They who can give up essential liberty to obtain a little temporary safety deserve neither liberty nor safety.” —** Benjamin Franklin
2. ‘Eternal vigilance is the price of liberty’.
3. *Identity is pivotal to one's being. - Shakespeare*
4. Each person possesses an **inviolability founded on justice** that even the welfare of society as a whole cannot override. - Rawls.
5. Society is like a chain, the weakest link is as important as the strongest link. - Rawls
6. Man is born free and everywhere in chains. — Rousseau
7. Nozick - You can’t satisfy everybody, especially if there are those who won’t be satisfied until all are satisfied.
8. There are people everywhere on the city streets, but the stranger could not be more alone if it were empty.







Love/Faith/Charity/Compassion

> *Ancient Egyptians had a beautiful belief about death. When their souls got to the entrance to heaven, the guards asked two questions. Their answers determined whether they were able to enter or not.* ***‘Have you found joy in your life?’ ‘Has your life brought joy to others?’***

4.3 Compassion: Essay Topics

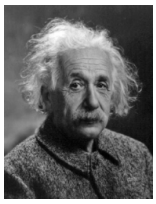
https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/





1. Someone is sitting in the shade today because someone planted a tree long time ago. — Warren Buffet
2. **'Faith is the bird that feels the light when the dawn is still dark.' - Tagore**
3. **'Life is given to us, we earn it by giving it'**. — Tagore
4. Your genius may take you to heights; but whether you stay there depends on your **character**." – Albert Einstein
5. Darkness can't drive out darkness, only light can do that. Hate cannot drive out hate, only love can do that. - MLK
6. "A man dies when he refuses to stand up for that which is **right/just/true.**" — Martin Luther King





> *A student once asked **anthropologist Margaret Mead, "What is the earliest sign of civilisation?"** Margaret Mead thought for a moment, then she said, "**A healed femur**." A femur is the longest bone in the body, linking hip to knee which took about six weeks of rest to heal if fractured. A healed femur shows that someone cared for the injured person. The first sign of civilisation is **compassion**, seen in a healed femur.*





- **Nicholas Winton, a young stockbroker in England, saved 669 children from the Holocaust.**

Examples: —

1. **Mother Teresa — convinced the Nobel Peace Prize committee to cancel a dinner in her honor, using the money instead to "feed 400 poor children for a year in India."**
    a. **UN in 2013, declared every September 5 (her death anniversary) as the 'International Day of Charity'.**
2. Dorothy Bowles, the wife of a U.S. Ambassador introduced simple techniques to help Indian workers such as adding a stick to the conventional broom which could be plied with an upright stance.
3. Prakash Baba Amte: His charity and work especially towards people suffering from Leprosy.
4. Hailing from **Gujarat's Bhavnagar, 84 year old retired bank employee Janardan Bhatt** and his wife donated Rs 1 crore to National Defence Fund that is their entire life savings.
5. **Harrison, known as the "Man With the Golden Arm,"** has donated blood (with unique, disease-fighting antibodies) nearly every week for 60 years. **He has helped saved the lives of more than 2.4 million Australian babies.**

Media

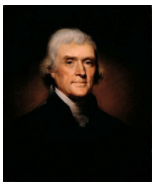
1.7 Media, TV & Cinema: Essay Topics

> *Intro: **Technological breakthroughs have revolutionised communications and the spread of information**.*
> *In 1880 - Telephone breached distance through sound.*
> *By 1910s, the first AM radio stations began to broadcast sound.*
> *By 1940s television was broadcasting both sound and visuals to a vast public.*
> *In 1970s, Computers became accessible to the public.*
> *In 2000s, the Internet.*

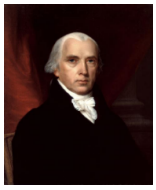
Temporal scale for Media: — 1. Ashokan Pillar 2. Gutenberg press — Bible and 3. Computer/Mobile Screens.

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/









1. *Thomas Jefferson* - "I will prefer *free press* and *no government* rather than *government without free press*."
2. **'Whoever controls the media, controls the mind' — John Morrison.**
3. "In the terrible history of famines in the world, **no substantial famine has ever occurred in any democratic country with a relatively free press." - Amartya Sen**
4. "The advancement and diffusion of knowledge is the only guardian of true liberty." — James Madison
5. "People are sheep. TV is the shepherd." - Jess C Scott
6. UNESCO: Press freedom and good governance are not mutually exclusive.
7. **Best line Cyber Security - 'It is not for the gunsmiths to decide who should use the gun and how'.**



Maria Ressa — Journalist from Philippines who got Nobel Peace Prize!

- It is an existential moment for World as **our information ecosystem, it's like an atom bomb exploded.** And we need to come together globally and find a solution, much like the world did after WW-II, they created the UN, Universal Declaration of Human Rights such as "tech values", beyond making money, and for tech companies to take the **role of being the gatekeeper to the public sphere seriously.**
- Use of social media lead to an erosion of trust in [mainstream media]. When citizens are being manipulated by parties on social media, they begin to distrust everything.

Our greatest crisis comes from "palaeolithic emotions, medieval institutions and Modern Godlike technology"

- The Arab Spring became an Arab Winter. At the beginning, Social media was empowering the people but soon governments realised they could exploit the same empowering platform by manipulating it and thus social media the weaknesses of people.

"Digital Authoritarians" are "weaponising the internet".

- WF: The first thing is that journalists, news organisations [must move] from the age when we were competing against each other. We are on the same side. Collaboration is the way forward.

Media in Positive light: —

1. **Hindu's Bofors Expose (1987)**

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

    a. **The Bofors scandal that broke in 1987 marked a watershed for India** — it was the first-time corruption became an intensely public and political issue.
    b. Almost 200 documents relating to Bofors were secretly sourced, verified and translated from the Swedish language before being published along with interviews and analytical pieces.
2. **Watergate Scandal USA (1972)**
    a. **Reported by Washington Post and New York Times**
    b. **Led to the resignation of President Richard Nixon**
3. **Tehelka's Defence Deals Expose in 2001**
    a. Carried out using hidden cameras, the investigation **(called Operation West End)** publicised secret videotapes of top politicians, bureaucrats and military official accepting bribes from two reporters (who posed as arms agents).
    b. The resulting furore created a major political storm and led to the resignation of those indicted by the videotapes.
4. **Indian National Movement**
    a. Censorship of Press Act, 1799
    b. Licensing Regulations, 1823
    c. Press Act of 1835.
5. **American Revolution**
    a. For American colonies, print acted as a binding agent that mitigated the chances that the colonies would not support one another when war with Britain broke out in 1775.
    b. Stories that appeared in each paper were "*exchanged*" from other papers in different cities, creating a uniform effect akin to a modern news wire.

> *For Social Media/Internet: — **The Strak Reality of Internet today is the digital divide:** The gap between technological haves and have nots is widening.*
>
> ***Information revolution, unlike the French Revolution, is based on lot of liberty and some fraternity and no equality**.*

Media in negative light: —

1. Everything is fair in love, war and breaking news. Social media, by nature, **rewards speed and sensationalism, not verification and caution.**
2. **While Truth was tying its Shoe Laces, Lie traveled half of the World.**
3. Book: → **Manufacturing Consent — Noam Chomsky:** Chomsky developed a **'propaganda model' of the mass media** which explains how **news and political coverage are distorted by the structures of the media** itself and apply filters of **'agents of power'.**
4. **Tacitus trap - describes a situation where no matter what the government says or does, people will consider it a lie or a bad deed. Tacitus trap of China might lead to Thucydides trap.**
5. If I want to knock a story off the front page, I just change my hairstyle. - Hillary Clinton

Examples:

- **Fake news and deliberate misleading** of the public happens from the top through people who wield power - Study by **Reuters Institute for the Study of Journalism, University of Oxford**
- **Clickbait journalism - Derivative of *yellow* journalism** - Exaggerations of news events, scandal-mongering, or sensationalism.
- **Paid Journalism/Chequebook journalism** - **2018 Cobrapost sting operation on Times Group**; Agenda Journalism;

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

- **'Bois Locker room' - Instagram** - Child rape → More 'copycat' groups after coming limelight.
- **Facebook apologised for its role in the 2018 anti-Muslim riots in Sri Lanka**. In-house probe found that incendiary content on the social media platform may have led to
- **Russia's interference in the 2016 U.S. election**. Facebook conceded that up to 10 million Americans had seen advertisements purchased by a Russian agency.

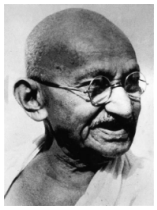
Solution: — **Code of Conduct - PCI, Regulatory framework to enforce cross-media ownership restriction.**

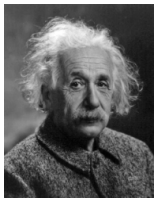
Peace/Justice

4 Quote based, Philosophy, Ethics: Essay Topics

> ***Costa Rica**, has set an inspiring example in IR by abolishing its armed forces in 1948 with a declared vow to spend the scarce **resources on education and healthcare instead of arms and ammunition**. It has remained as a role model of peaceful democracy in Central America while its neighbours have gone through devastating civil wars and military dictatorships. Costa Rica has a University of Peace to infuse the culture of peace in IR.*

> *We Passed their grave;*
> *The dead man there,*
> *Winners or Losers,*
> *Did not care.*
> *In the dark*
> *They could not see*
> *Who had gained*
> *The Victory.*







1. The greatness of humanity is not in being human, but in **being humane. - Gandhi**
2. "If we are to teach real peace in this world," wrote Gandhi, "we shall have to begin with the children."
3. "I don't know not with what weapons World War III will be fought, but World War IV will be fought with sticks and stones." - **Einstein**
4. **Mankind must put an end to war, or war will put an end to mankind. — John F. Kennedy**
5. Justice would loose its character if it becomes revenge (on encounter) → **CJI Bobde**
6. Mother Teresa was brilliant. She said, "I will never attend an anti-war rally. If you have a peace rally, invite me."
7. *Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam*, *Ahimsa as Dharma.* (Duty)
8. The **Preamble** to the Constitution of **UNESCO** declares that "Since wars begin in the minds of men, it is in the minds of men that the defences of peace must be constructed".
9. War clearly blurs the distinction between logic and superstition.







> ***Righteousness in heart → Beauty in character → Harmony in home → Order in nation → Peace in world. - APJ.***

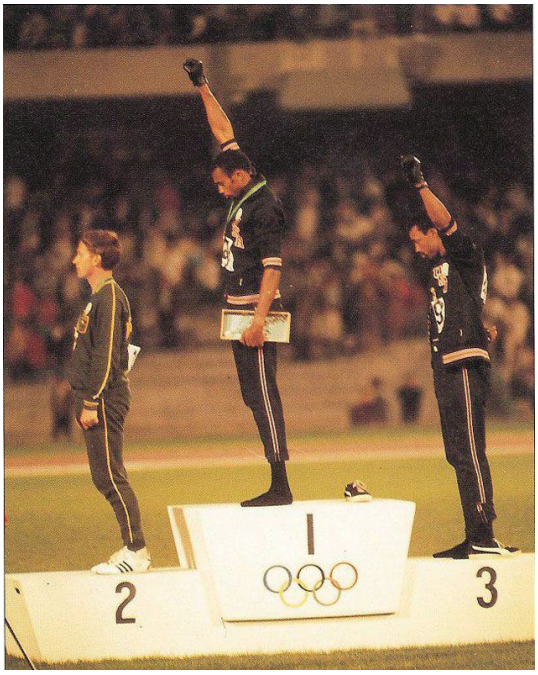
https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/

Examples: —

1. **Ashoka's Dhamma** was a cultural conquest rather than a military one. It was to create a harmonious atmosphere in the state where everyone irrespective of religion and cultural diversities lied in peace and harmony with each other.
2. Similarly, **Akbar's policy of universal peace** (Sulh-i-kul) also provided modern values. These values resembled modern ideas of peace, harmony, and tolerance but were not essentially western.

Poverty/Inequality



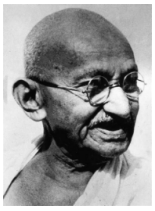
In **1968** Mexico Olympics, US athletes **Tommie Smith and John Carlos** protested by wearing black socks (Showing Black Poverty) and black gloves (Showing Black Power) with their head bowed during US National Anthem. This was in order to bring international attention towards the discrimination against African-American in USA. This incident took place during the **Civil Rights Moment.**

2nd Place → Peter Norman wore a Human Rights Badge in support. Later, he was excluded from Australia teams for next olympics. He said "I will stand with you."

And Tommie and John were deprived of their medals by Olympic Committee by breaking the spirit of the games and making a political statement.

The athletes in the example above were responding to social divisions and social inequalities.

1.5 Poverty, Social Justice: Essay Topics





1. "Poverty is the worst form of violence." **Gandhi.** Solution **- Trusteeship.**
2. **"Wealth is so concentrated that a large segment of society is virtually unaware of its existence" — Piketty.**
3. Extreme poverty anywhere is a threat to human security everywhere." — Kofi Annan
4. "Poverty is like punishment for a crime you didn't commit." — Eli Khamarov
5. "Our real enemy is not the **neighbouring country; it is *hunger, poverty, ignorance, superstition & prejudice***." - Henry Dunant (*Founder: Red Cross*)
6. "The test of our progress is whether we provide enough for those who have little." – Franklin Roosevelt
7. "**We must ask searching questions to the symbols of injustice. Unless we do that, we risk becoming the cause and not just the inheritors of an unjust society.**" - Justice







https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/



Chandrachud.

8. The opposite of loneliness is not **freedom** but **fraternity. — Justice DYC**
9. Overcoming poverty is not a gesture of charity. It is an act of justice. It is the protection of fundamental human right, the right to dignified life."
10. Inequality resembles the mythological serpent Hydra in Greek mythology — as the state attempts to deal with one aspect of in equality, many new aspects keep coming up.

> *Gita - As much as is necessary for one's own living only that much one is entitled to have.* ***One who has excess of this is a thief and deserves punishment.***

> ***Conclusion****: In his speech —* ***'Freedom at midnight', Nehru*** *mentioned, "****The ambition of the greatest men of our generation has been to wipe every tear from every eye****. That may be beyond us, but as long as there are tears and suffering, so long our work will not be over."*

Other types of Poverty:

1. Education Poverty (Learning Poverty — World Bank)
2. **Politico-geographic poverty: → Civil war and politically unstable countries** are also one of the causes of poverty.
3. Moral poverty is also a manifestation of poverty, of which **corruption is a Goliath scourge**.

Data: —

1. **Oxfam - 2019 report - 26 billionaires as many assets as the 3.8 billion people** who make up the poorest half of the planet's population.
2. **Global Social Mobility Index showed - lower inequality - higher social mobility.**
3. Coronavirus || **60 million could be pushed into extreme poverty in 2020: — World Bank President**

Examples: —

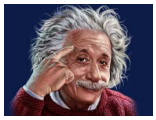
1. **Jyoti Kumari** - 15 year old - cycled 1200 km over 8 days. Carrying her injured father - Gurugram to Bihar. Thrown out of their house as unable to pay rent.
2. **Angus Deaton - "The Great Escape"** - prisoners - tunnels - escape - Nazi camp. Freedom. (Parallels - Industrial Revolution or reforms initiation in India). It is those left behind who suffer the consequences - reduced freedom.

Religion/Secularism

7.1 Science and Religion: Essay Topics



1. 'India's long tradition of religious tolerance can be a role model for rest of the world.' — Dalai Lama
2. "The most certain test by which we judge whether a country is really free is the **amount of security enjoyed by minorities.**" - Lord Acton
3. "Science without Religion is lame and Religion without Science is blind". — Einstein





https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/



4. **Sarva Dharma Sama Bhava** – [Ramakrishna Paramahamsa and Vivekananda] All religions are equal — first used by Mahatma Gandhi in 1930 in Harijan
5. **"Our scientific power has outrun our spiritual power. We have guided missiles and misguided men." — MLK**
6. "Religion is opium of Masses" — Marx





Refugee

6 International issues, Internal Security: Essay Topics

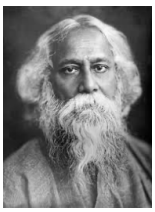
1.5 Poverty, Social Justice: Essay Topics

> *Intro:* ***Poem titled 'Refugees' by Brian Bilston*** *— First read top to bottom, then again read from bottom to top.*
>
> *They have no need of our help*
> *So do not tell me...*
> *These haggard faces could belong to you or me*
> *Should life have dealt a different hand...'*



> *For millions of immigrants, their first glimpse of America was the Statue of Liberty in New York harbor. The statue – with its famous engraved poem about* ***embracing the "huddled masses, yearning to breathe free"*** *– greeted ships carrying the poor and persecuted. Today, amid the ongoing refugee crisis, the Statue of Liberty has become newly relevant:* ***a humane symbol of tolerance and welcome****, it stands in counterpoint to harrowing reports of razor-wire fences, tear gas, and water cannons at closed borders.*





- Patriotism cannot be our final shelter; my refuge is humanity. I will not buy glass for the price of diamonds. – **Rabindranath Tagore**
- 'I am proud to belong to a nation which has sheltered the persecuted and the **refugees of all religions and all nations of the Earth**". - Vivekananda.



"Vasudaiva Kutumbakam"

Facts:

1. As per **Global Trends Report 2018** of UNHCR, **68.5 mn** people displaced at the end of 2017.
    a. **Over 50%** of the displaced population is children.
2. **UNHCR** predicts that in the next 50 years upto **1 billion** humans could leave their homes because of climate change.

Science & Technology

SnT Essay Remarks: — "S&T is the Panacea for the growth and security of the nation"

- Growth v/s Security — Different Subheading?!

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

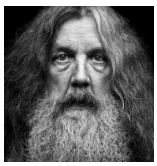
https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/

    - No.
- Security Dimensions?
    - A
- “**the**” nation?
    - A
- Growth —
    - Inclusive Growth
    - Biotechnology = Growth - Genetics (Health)!
- Concerns —
    - Growth specific —
        - Mob Warfare: Mob Lynching.
        - Biotechnology = Growth - Genetics (Health)!
    - Security —
        -
- Futuristic —
    - I.R. 4.0
    - Biotechnology
    - Nanotechnology

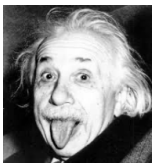
---

7 Science-Technology: Essay Topics

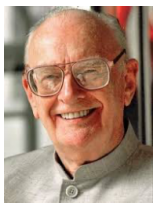
> *When Archimedes cried 'Eureka'! it was not just an expression of excitement on a new discovery, but a* ***statement on the entire experience of innovation and discovery.***







1. “**Ideas are Bulletproof**” — Alan Moore.
2. "Technology is a useful servant but a dangerous master." — **Christian Lange**
3. Human spirit must prevail over technology - **Albert Einstein**
4. **The only way to discover the limits of possible is to go beyond them into the impossible** - Arthur Clarke
5. Any sufficiently advanced technology is indistinguishable from Magic. - Arthur Clark
6. Humanity is acquiring all the right technology for all the wrong reasons. - R. Buckminster Fuller
7. **“Our scientific power has outrun our spiritual power. We have guided missiles and misguided men”. - Martin Luther King Jr**
8. **The Internet has not just open-sourced information; it has also open-sourced insecurity, self-doubt, and shame.**
9. Technology will change more in next 20 years than it did in last 2000.
10. One Century’s magic is another Century’s Science. One Century’s Science is another’s nuisance







https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

a. **Thomas Midgley in 1928 invented CFCs called it 'miracle gas'** to replace then used volatile gases; now it is causing ozone holes.



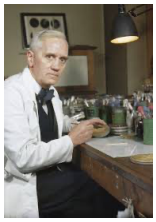


> ***Isaac Asimov - Short story - 1955 - Electronic democracy*** *- Single citizen was chosen to represent the entire population based on answers to computer generated questions.*

> *1955 — Jonas Salk did not patent his Polio vaccine.*

> ***Invention of Penicillin*** *during 1928 by the Scottish scientist Alexander Fleming could be considered as the beginning of the modern era of medicine.*

> *As early as in **1962, Rachel Carson** in her classic book titled Silent Spring pointed out that pesticides including DDT can result in long-term harm because of their long residual toxicity*



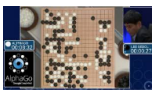


Examples:









1. MIT professor Daron Acemoglu - "**so-so technologies**" that disrupt employment and without generating a boost in productivity or quality of service — Eg. - Automated customer service.
2. **AI when ordered to design a most efficient drone — arrived at the design of skeleton of Pelvis of Flying Squirrel.**
3. 1997 — Deep Blue beats World Champions Garry Kasparov at Chess.
4. **Deep Mind beats Best Mind at 'Go' — Lee Sedol performing more calculations than no. of atoms in Universe.**
5. 'Café Scientifique' — First such initiative in Kerala to promote science among public + a grassroots initiative based on the French café philosophique model.
6. Suicides of Sneha (1st Year) and Amerpreet (Class 7) due to admonishment for overuse of cellphone by Parents. (Technology > Human Spirit)

"Humans are underrated"

AI

> *Stephen Hawking — '**The development of full AI could spell the end of the human race.**'*

- AI will help us move from:
  - **Constructed to Grown (3D Printing)**
  - **Isolated to Connected**
  - **Extraction to Aggregation**
  - **Obedience to Autonomy**

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

> *Facebook has been using AI to detect self-harm and prevent suicides since March 2017 — In recent incident - Dhule 23 Years old person was saved by FB and Mumbai Cyber Police.*

Initiatives:

1. MHRD Innovation Cell (MIC)
2. Atal ranking of Institutions on Innovation Achievements (*ARIIA*)
3. **Global Initiative for Academic Network (GIAN)**
4. **Scheme for Academic research and Promotion by collaboration (SPARC)**
5. Impacting research Innovation and Technology (IMPrINT)
6. **Uchhatar Avishkar Yojana (UAY)**

	A	B	C
1	**Industrial Revolution**	**Timeline**	**Remarks**
2	First	18th to 19th centuries	Europe and America. Turned agrarian and rural societies into industrial and urban. Example- Iron and textile industries and steam engine.
3	Second	1870 to 1914 (WW - I)	Steel, oil and electricity sectors. Major technological advances included the telephone, light bulb and internal combustion engine.
4	Third	1980s onwards	Also called Digital Revolution, it includes the personal computer, internet and information and communication technology (ICT).
5	Fourth	**WEF, 2016**	It includes robotics, artificial intelligence, nanotechnology, quantum computing, biotechnology, The Internet of Things (IoT), 3D printing and autonomous vehicles.

Terrorism

6.3 Security: Essay Topics

6.2 International Org./ Bilateral: Essay Topics

> *If this belief from heaven be sent,*
> *If such be Nature's holy plan,*
> *Have I not reason to lament*
> *What man has made of man?*
> *— "Lines Written in Early Spring" —* ***William Wordsworth***

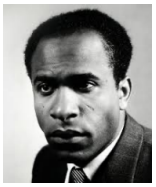


Intro: *Origin*: 1793-94 France: **Mass Execution *by* Jacobians led by *Robbespiere* termed as "*Rule of Terror*".**





1. "The only thing necessary for the triumph of evil is for good men to do nothing". - Edmund Burke
2. "With guns you can kill terrorists, with education you can kill terrorism". - **Malala Yousafzai**
3. On one hand, we want to fight terrorism; on the other, we cannot define it. - Sushma Swaraj at UNGA.
4. "Fervour is the weapon of impotent" — Frantz Fanon
5. Lee Kuan Yew said, preventing terrorist attacks requires that we eliminate the "queen bees" (Masterminds) who are inspiring the "worker bees" (suicide bombers) to become martyrs.





https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/



Examples: →



1. **Robert Grenier**, the CIA's former station chief in Pakistan, said that the United States's drone programme created more terrorists than it eliminated. Hence, counter-radicalisation is necessary. **Maharashtra ATS - by now 120 youths have been successfully counter-radicalised.**
    a. Otherwise we will be **killing a python to give rise to numerous snakes**



2. Margaret Thatcher: — "*Oxygen of publicity*" — Highly published atrocities.
3. Noam Chomsky called **USA as the world's *'leading terrorist state'.*** (Terrorism in middle east is attributed to geo-political objectives of USA FP!)



4. Till the end of CW, Terrorism was a peripheral issues but after 9/11 it became a core issue in International Politics.
5. *India proposed* ***CCIT (Comprehensive Convention on International Terrorism) - 1996!***

Touri$m

2.4 Sectors of Economy: Essay Topics



1. **"The journey is the destination." — Dan Eldon**
2. "The world is a book and those who do not travel read only one page". St. Augustin



Examples: —

1. **`Live Gandhi For A While'** a tourist programme - Nischal Barot - 2016 Ahmedabad -- named as Responsible Tourism as it is against the destination based tourism based on commercial interests. To live like Gandhi in Ashram in austere way for min. 5 days.
2. 2017 — UN GA declared "International Year for Sustainable tourism Development"

Women Empowerment

5 Women empowerment: Essay Topics



1. *To awaken the people, it is the women who must be awakened. Once she is on the move, the family moves, the village moves, the nation moves - Nehru*
2. "You educate a man; you educate a man. You educate a woman; you educate a generation." — Brigham Young
3. I measure the progress of a community by the degree of progress which women have achieved." - B. R. Ambedkar



https://upscpdf.com/ https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/







4. “One is not born, but rather becomes, a woman” — Simone de Beauvoir
5. **"For most of history, Anonymous was a woman." — Virginia Woolf.**
6. **‘We can** be **blind to the obvious**, but **we** are also **blind to our blindness’. – Nobel Laureate Daniel Kahneman.**
7. There is no tool more effective than empowerment of women for development of a country - Kofi Annan
8. No chance of the welfare of the world until the condition of women is improved. **It is not possible for a bird to fly with one wing” - Vivekananda**
9. *The women moved toward the door, but the door was blocked—by loyalty, by obedience. By her father.*







Examples: →

1. A Women from Calcutta - Left home at age of 17 to run away from arranged marriage and to pursue her passion to study biochemistry. She left home with nothing except a pair of diamond earrings which she sold to buy tickets of Plane to Boston to study under Linus Pauling. Despite the odds, She had one asset she never had - **A Free Will**. She began from washing dishes, doing household chores. Meanwhile educating herself and investing. She is now founder of multi-million dollar company ‘Activator’ through sheer courage and hard-work. **The woman is Chanda Zaveri - ‘A woman who set herself free’.**
2. **Sudha Murthy - IISC - ‘anti-Women bias’ TELCO employment policy**, as it mentioned women need not apply - she wrote letter to TELCO chairman - TELCO offered Special interview to her - 1st women engineer hired by TELCO.
3. Gangandeep Kang (1st Indian women in Royal Society), Rani Lakshmi Bai.
4. **Chhavi Rajawat** - Soda Village, Rajasthan Sarpanch - Studied from SRCC.
5. Our institutions are very patriarchal: Soumya Swaminathan — WHO’s Chief Scientist says she had faced many kinds of challenges and biases during her ICMR stint
6. The **first all women contingent** in any UN peacekeeping mission, a Former Police Unit from India, was deployed in **2007 to the UN Operation in Liberia tp prevent violence against women and girls.**









> ***Conclusion**: It is essential to recognise that their struggle is a struggle not merely confined to gender but it is the struggle of every right minded and patriotic Indian Citizen who wants a more just and more equal India.*

https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/



In 1912, Jim Thorpe, an American Indian, had his running shoes stolen the morning of his Olympic track and field events. He found this mismatched pair of shoes in the garbage and ran in them to win two Olympic gold medals that day.



In 1967, Kathrine Switzer (20) (bib number 261) lined up to run the Boston Marathon at a time when women weren't permitted to compete. At mile two a race official tried to stop her, but Switzer finished in 4:20, making history. #261.

UN

6.2 International Org./ Bilateral: Essay Topics







1. Ban Ki Moon - "We need more UN than less UN".
2. **Dag Hammarskjöld** famously said that the United Nations "was **not created to take mankind to heaven, but to save humanity from hell.**
3. USA President Truman - "UN is creation of nation-state. It is malleable to their wishes. If they wish it will succeed, otherwise, it will become relic of the past".
4. "More than ever before in **human history, we share a common destiny**. We can master it only if we **face it together**. And that is why we have the United Nations." — Kofi Annan.
5. Jeffry Sachs:→ *Most Important innovation of 20th Century*.
6. **UN reform is a malady where all the doctors around the patient agree on the diagnosis, but they can't agree on the prescription.**
7. We need to convert Global Jungle into a Zoo. (Global Anarchy into Rule based order)





The fear for UN is not its extinction but irrelevance.

India and UN:

1. Kofi Annan*:* India has been one of the most *significant votaries of shaping the UN agenda on behalf of the developing world.*
2. **India should get its *rightful place* in the *comity* of nations** which it deserves because of *its great civilisation.* - Nehru

https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/

https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/

3. S. Jaishankar: → ***If regimes and institutions are to be credible, they must also be contemporary.***

Examples/Instances:

1. **Acheson Plan - USA** - initial steps to reform UN. General assembly power to override the veto of security council. Didn't materialise.
2. **UN charter - Article 2 sub-clause 7 - UN can't interfere in the domestic matters of a state** - couldn't help in **Rwandan genocide.**
3. UN reforms need amendment to UN charter - 2/3rd majority in GA and ratification - Coffee club blocking.
4. Recent triggers - China vetoed any discussion on its COVID handling in UNSC.
5. Former PR to UN Hardeep Puri called **UNSC's functioning as 'Internal Chaos'.**

---

https://upscpdf.com/
https://upscpdf.com/